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History

The Making of the Constitution

Framing the Constitution: The Beginning of a New Era (1946–1950)

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INSIDE
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INSIDE
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Module 1: The Historical Crucible & Genesis of the Constituent Assembly

1.1 The Tumultuous Context of Framing (1946–1947)

The Indian Constitution was drafted against a background of catastrophic upheaval. Between 1946 and 1949, the subcontinent was convulsed by the violence of Partition, mass displacement of millions of Hindu, Muslim, and Sikh refugees, and the acute challenge of integrating **565 princely states** into a unified federal polity.

The Constituent Assembly was convened in New Delhi under the provisions of the **Cabinet Mission Plan of 1946**. It met for the first time on **9 December 1946**. Following the Mountbatten Plan (3 June 1947) and Partition, the Muslim League boycotted the Assembly, and its membership was reconstituted from the original 389 down to **299 members**.

- **Mode of Election:** The members were not elected by universal adult franchise. Instead, they were **indirectly elected** by the provincial legislative assemblies (elected in early 1946) through proportional representation with the single transferable vote. Representatives of the princely states were chosen through negotiation and nomination.
- **Party Composition:** The Indian National Congress occupied **82% of the seats** in the reconstituted Assembly. However, the Congress was far from monolithic; it was a broad, pluralistic umbrella organization comprising socialists, free-market capitalists, agrarian traditionalists, secular modernizers, and devout Gandhians.

CUET HIGH-YIELD: REPRESENTATION IN THE ASSEMBLY

- **Dr. Sachchidananda Sinha:** The oldest member, elected as the temporary / interim Chairman on 9 December 1946 following the French practice.
- **Dr. Rajendra Prasad:** Elected as the permanent President of the Constituent Assembly on 11 December 1946.
- **H.C. Mookherjee & V.T. Krishnamachari:** Elected as the two Vice-Presidents of the Assembly.

1.2 The Congress Triumvirate & Drafting Leadership

Six individuals played dominant roles in shaping the constitutional deliberations:

1. **Jawaharlal Nehru:** Formulated the overarching democratic and socialist vision; moved the landmark **Objectives Resolution** (13 December 1946); chaired the Union Powers Committee, Union Constitution Committee, and States Committee.
2. **Vallabhbhai Patel:** Deputy Prime Minister and Home Minister; master of political realism and consensus; chaired the Advisory Committee on Fundamental Rights, Minorities, and Tribal Areas, and the Provincial Constitution Committee; secured the integration of princely states.
3. **Dr. Rajendra Prasad:** As Assembly President, steered debates with non-partisan equanimity, ensuring that opposing perspectives received fair hearings.

4. **Dr. B.R. Ambedkar:** Appointed on 29 August 1947 as the **Chairman of the 7-member Drafting Committee**. As Law Minister, he steered the draft clause by clause, infusing the text with constitutional morality and protections for oppressed classes.
5. **Sir Benegal Narsing Rau (B.N. Rau): Constitutional Advisor** to the Assembly. Prepared the initial draft after an exhaustive comparative study of the constitutions of the USA, UK, Ireland, Canada, and Australia.
6. **Surendra Nath Mukherjee (S.N. Mukherjee): Chief Draftsman** of the Assembly. Praised by Ambedkar for his extraordinary legal skill in translating complex political compromises into precise, unambiguous statutory prose.

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Module 2: The Objectives Resolution & Democratic Foundations

2.1 Nehru's Objectives Resolution (13 December 1946)

On **13 December 1946**, Jawaharlal Nehru moved the historic **Objectives Resolution**, which outlined the philosophical ideals and structural architecture of the future republic. It was unanimously adopted on **22 January 1947** and later inspired the **Preamble** of the Constitution.

""We say that it is our firm and solemn resolve to have an Independent Sovereign Republic… There is no doubt that only a democratic constitution would be acceptable here… We are not going just to copy, I hope, a certain democratic procedure or an institution of a so-called democratic country.""

Core Principles of the Resolution:

- **Sovereignty:** India was declared an Independent Sovereign Republic whose power and authority derive entirely from the sovereign people.
- **Justice & Equality:** Guarantees of social, economic, and political justice; equality of status, opportunity, and before the law.
- **Safeguards for the Marginalized:** Adequate safeguards promised for minorities, backward and tribal areas, and depressed classes.
- **Global Role:** Commitment to international peace and the welfare of mankind.

2.2 Universal Adult Franchise: The Bold Leap of Faith

One of the most revolutionary decisions of the Constituent Assembly was the unconditional adoption of **Universal Adult Franchise** (Article 326).

While Western democracies (such as Britain, France, and the United States) had granted voting rights slowly over centuries—initially restricting franchise to property-owning males and only gradually enfranchising the working class and women—India granted the vote simultaneously to every adult citizen aged 21 and above (reduced to 18 by the 61st Amendment in 1988), regardless of gender, caste, religion, wealth, or literacy. In a country where over 85% of the population was illiterate and impoverished, this was an unprecedented democratic leap.

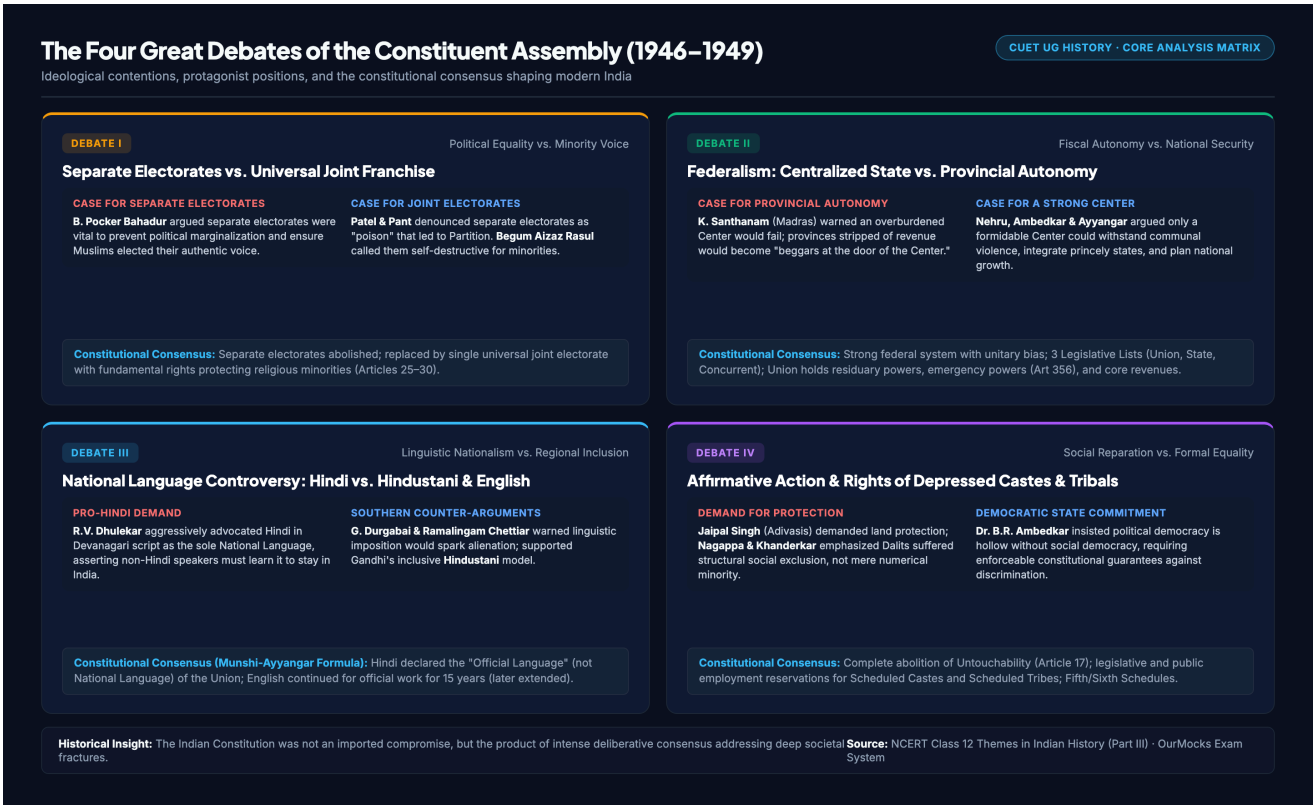


Figure 1: Matrix Analysis of the Four Great Constitutional Debates in the Assembly

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Module 3: Key Debates: Rights, Minorities & Social Equity

3.1 The Debate on Separate Electorates

The question of electoral representation for religious minorities was fiercely contested in the shadow of Partition:

- **The Case for Separate Electorates: B. Pocker Bahadur** (a Muslim League member from Madras) argued on 27 August 1947 that separate electorates were indispensable. He asserted that in a joint electorate, minorities would be overwhelmed by the majority and only those minority candidates who were subservient to the majority party would be elected.
- **The Nationalist Rebuttal:**
  - **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel** declared that separate electorates were an imperialist poison that had produced the vivisection of India:

"“It was by the introduction of this principle that British imperialism entrenched itself... Do you want to divide the nation again? If so, say it openly.”"

  - **Govind Ballabh Pant** argued that separate electorates were suicidal for minorities, permanently isolating them from the national mainstream: **“If you isolate them, you make them vulnerable. What purpose can it serve?”**
  - **Begum Aizaz Rasul** (the only Muslim woman member of the Assembly) supported Patel, declaring separate electorates to be self-destructive, as they alienated minorities from their fellow citizens.

- **The Consensus:** Separate electorates were abolished. In their place, the Constitution instituted a single universal joint electorate, while safeguarding religious minorities through fundamental rights to religious freedom, culture, and education (**Articles 25–30**).

3.2 The Rights of Depressed Castes & Untouchability

The Assembly engaged in passionate debates on how to dismantle millennia of caste oppression:

- **Social vs. Political Democracy: Dr. B.R. Ambedkar** warned that political freedom would remain an illusion if social inequality persisted:

""On the 26th of January 1950, we are going to enter into a life of contradictions. In politics we will have equality and in social and economic life we will have inequality… How long shall we continue to deny equality in our social and economic life?""

- **Voice of the Marginalized:** Members like **J. Nagappa** (Madras), **K.J. Khanderkar** (Central Provinces), and **Dakshayani Velayudhan** (the only Dalit woman member) pointed out that Dalits were not a numerical minority, but an oppressed majority who had been systematically denied access to land, education, and human dignity. Nagappa stated: **"We have been gallantly led by our caste Hindu brethren for thousands of years... the result is that we are now reduced to the position of beggars."**
- **Constitutional Remedy:**
  - **Article 17:** Untouchability was completely abolished, and its practice in any form was made a punishable crime.
  - **Reservation:** Statutory reservation of seats in the Lok Sabha, State Assemblies, and public services was instituted for **Scheduled Castes (SC)** and **Scheduled Tribes (ST)**.

3.3 The Rights of Tribals (Adivasis)

Jaipal Singh, an Oxford-educated tribal leader and captain of India's 1928 Olympic gold hockey team, passionately championed the cause of the original inhabitants of India:

""As an Adivasi, I am not expected to understand the legal intricacies of the Resolution. But my common sense tells me that every one of us should march in that road to freedom… For the last six thousand years, my people have been systematically exploited, dispossessed of our lands, and driven into the jungles… You cannot teach my people democracy; we have practiced it for thousands of years.""

Jaipal Singh demanded that Adivasis not be treated as a religious minority, but as distinct indigenous societies requiring special protection against land alienation and commercial exploitation. The Assembly responded by formulating the **Fifth and Sixth Schedules**, providing specialized autonomous administration for tribal areas.

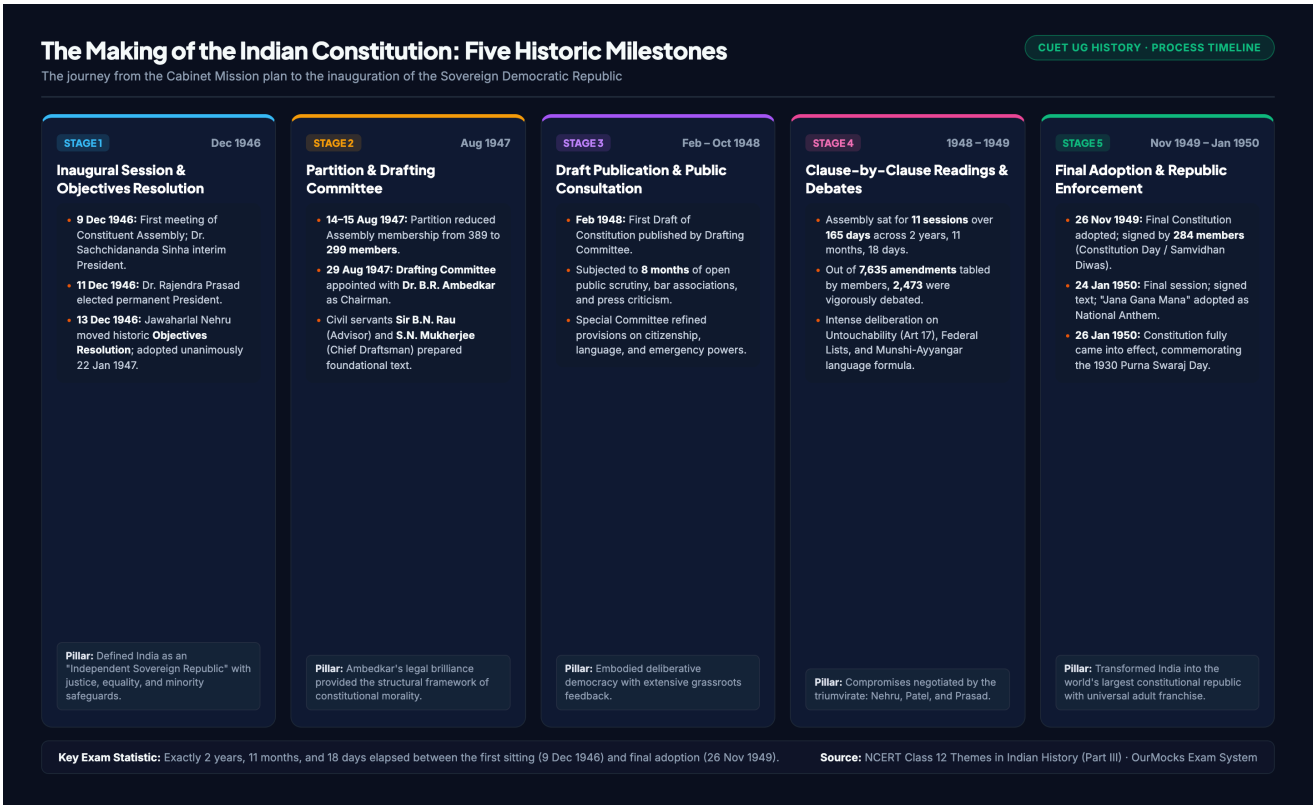


Figure 2: Chronological Milestones from Inaugural Sitting to Republic Enforcement (1946–1950)

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Module 4: Federal Architecture: Central Power vs. Provincial Autonomy

4.1 The Impetus for a Strong Center

The partition massacres, the refugee crisis, the threat of balkanization from recalcitrant princely rulers (such as Hyderabad, Junagadh, and Kashmir), and food shortages convinced leaders like **Jawaharlal Nehru**, **Dr. B.R. Ambedkar**, and **N. Gopalaswami Ayyangar** that only a centralized, formidable Union could preserve India's sovereignty.

Nehru declared that in the post-Partition context, a weak central government would be catastrophic: **"Now that Partition is a settled fact, it would be injurious to the interests of the country to provide for a weak central authority which would be incapable of ensuring peace, of coordinating vital matters of common concern and of speaking effectively for the whole country in the international sphere."**

4.2 The Critique of Over-Centralization

K. Santhanam (Madras) led the intellectual opposition against excessive centralization:

- He argued that an overburdened Center would inevitably falter: **"A strong Centre should not be confused with a Center that possesses all powers."**
- Santhanam pointed out that stripping provinces of fiscal resources would reduce them to administrative beggars: **"The provinces will have to beg the Centre for money to**

repair a school or dig a village well... If you do this, provincial autonomy will be a complete farce."

- He warned that over-centralization would provoke regional rebellions against New Delhi.

4.3 The Three Legislative Lists & Unitary Tilt

The Assembly adopted a compromise that created a federal system with a distinct **unitary bias**:

Union List (List I)	State List (List II)	Concurrent List (List III)
▸ **97 items** (Defence, Foreign Affairs, Currency, Railways, Atomic Energy, Ports). ▸ Sole legislative jurisdiction of Parliament.	▸ **66 items** (Police, Public Order, Agriculture, Prisons, Public Health, Local Self-Govt). ▸ Legislative jurisdiction of State Assemblies.	▸ **47 items** (Criminal Law, Civil Procedure, Marriage, Education, Forests, Trade Unions). ▸ Union law prevails in case of conflict.

Unitary Features Embedded in the Constitution:

- **Residuary Powers (Article 248):** Vested entirely in the Union Parliament (unlike the US Constitution where residuary powers belong to the states).
- **Emergency Powers (Articles 352, 356, 360):** Under Article 356 (President's Rule), the Center can dissolve state governments on the governor's report.
- **Integrated Judiciary & All-India Services:** Single unified supreme court and high courts, along with the IAS and IPS (Article 312).

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Module 5: The Language Controversy & The Munshi-Ayyangar Formula

5.1 The Clash of Linguistic Visions

Language proved to be the most explosive and emotionally charged issue in the Constituent Assembly:

- **The Gandhian Ideal of Hindustani:** Mahatma Gandhi had consistently championed **Hindustani**—a composite blend of Hindi and Urdu, spoken across North India and written in both Devanagari and Persian scripts—as the ideal national language because it reflected composite cultural synthesis and bridged communal divides.
- **The Aggressive Hindi Demand:** Following Partition, Hindu traditionalists rejected Hindustani as tainted by Islamic influence and demanded that Sanskritised Hindi written in Devanagari script be declared the sole **National Language**.
  - **R.V. Dhulekar** (United Provinces) delivered an aggressive speech on 12 September 1947:

""People who are present in this House to fashion a constitution for India and do not know Hindustani are not worthy to be members of this Assembly. The sooner they leave this House, the better.""

- **The Southern and Non-Hindi Resistance:** Members from non-Hindi-speaking regions responded with deep apprehension:
  - **Shrimati G. Durgabai** (Madras) warned that Hindi chauvinism was eroding the goodwill generated during the freedom movement: **"The aggressive advocacy of Hindi is causing intense bitterness in the South. You are isolating yourselves."**
  - **T.A. Ramalingam Chettiar** (Madras) warned that forcing Hindi would lead to regional disintegration: **"If you force this upon an unwilling people, it will lead to results which nobody will be happy about."**

5.2 The Munshi-Ayyangar Compromise Formula

To prevent the Assembly from fracturing along linguistic lines, a compromise formula was drafted by **K.M. Munshi** and **N. Gopalaswami Ayyangar**:

1. **Official Language vs. National Language:** Hindi in Devanagari script was declared the **Official Language** of the Union (**Article 343**). The Assembly deliberately avoided using the title "National Language" to respect India's multilingual diversity.
2. **Transition Period for English:** For an initial period of **15 years** (from 1950 to 1965), English was to continue to be used for all official purposes of the Union, inter-state correspondence, and high court/supreme court proceedings. (This was subsequently extended indefinitely by the **Official Languages Act of 1963**).
3. **International Numerals:** The international form of Indian numerals (1, 2, 3…) was adopted for official Union use rather than Devanagari numerals.
4. **Eighth Schedule:** Regional languages were recognized in the Eighth Schedule (originally 14 languages, now 22), granting each state the right to conduct administration in its regional language.

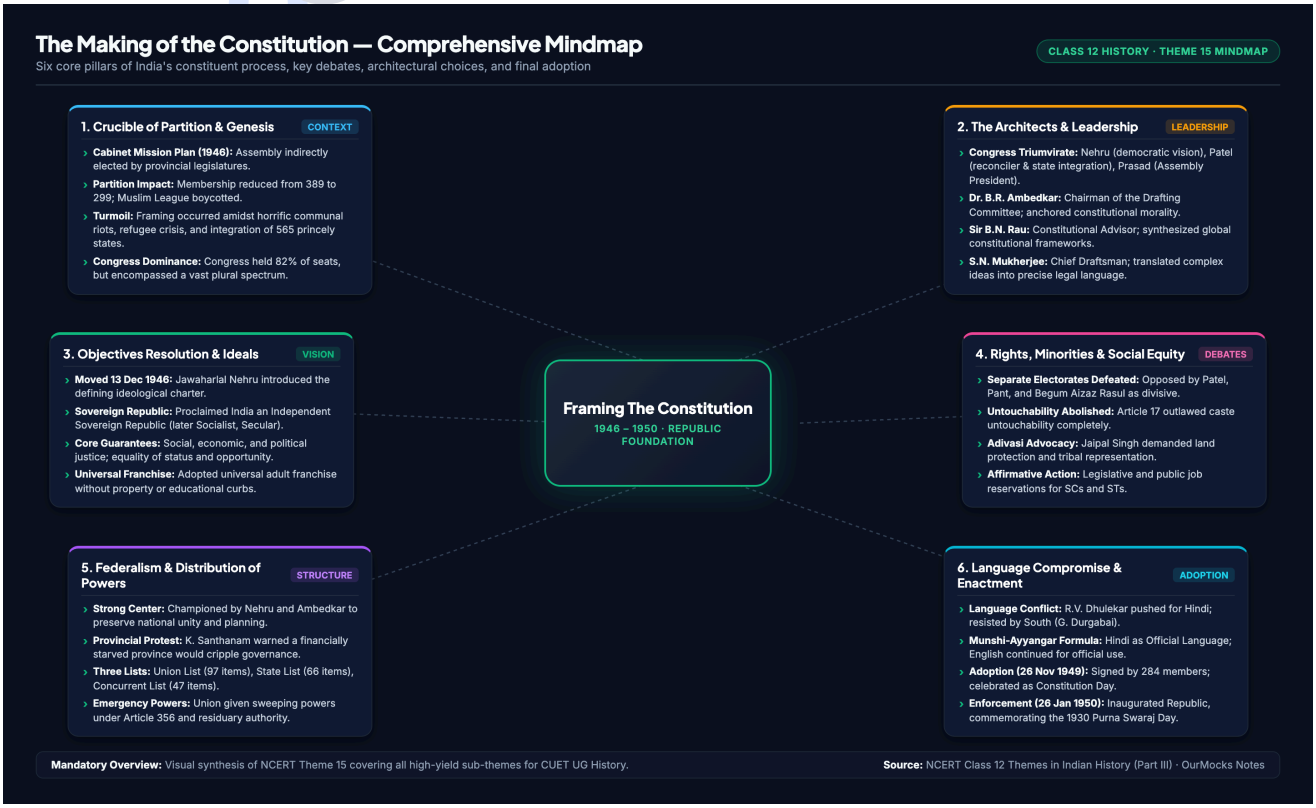


Figure 3: Comprehensive Mindmap: The Framing of the Indian Constitution (1946–1950)

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Module 6: Final Adoption, Enforcement & Historiographical Significance

6.1 The Enactment Milestones

The Constituent Assembly completed its colossal task after **11 sessions** spanning **165 days** over **2 years, 11 months, and 18 days**.

- Out of 7,635 amendments tabled, 2,473 were debated and disposed of on the floor.
- On **26 November 1949**, the Constitution of India was formally passed and adopted, signed by **284 members** present in the Constitution Hall. This date is celebrated nationwide as **Constitution Day** (**Samvidhan Diwas**).
- On **24 January 1950**, the Assembly met for its final sitting. The members signed two copies of the Constitution (one in English and one in Hindi, beautifully calligraphed by **Prem Behari Narain Raizada** and illuminated by artists of Shantiniketan under **Nandalal Bose**). **Dr. Rajendra Prasad** was elected as the first President of India.
- On **26 January 1950**, the Constitution came into full legal effect, marking the birth of the **Republic of India**. This date was deliberately chosen to commemorate the historic **Purna Swaraj Day** of 26 January 1930.

6.2 Ambedkar's Final Warning: The Triad of Liberty, Equality & Fraternity

In his closing speech to the Assembly on **25 November 1949**, Dr. B.R. Ambedkar delivered a timeless warning regarding the preservation of constitutional democracy:

1. **Abandon Direct Action Methods:** Nationalists must abandon the grammar of anarchy—satyagraha, civil disobedience, and strikes—now that constitutional channels for redress were open.
2. **Beware of Hero-Worship (Bhakti):** Quoting John Stuart Mill, he warned against laying personal liberties at the feet of great men: **"In politics, Bhakti or hero-worship is a sure road to degradation and to eventual dictatorship."**
3. **Social Democracy is Essential:** Political democracy cannot survive without social democracy: **"We must make our political democracy a social democracy as well. Political democracy cannot last unless there lies at the base of it social democracy."**

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Module 7: Major Committees & Global Constitutional Sources

7.1 Major Committees of the Constituent Assembly

The Constituent Assembly appointed several committees to examine specific areas of constitutional design:

Committee	Chairman	Core Mandate
Drafting Committee	Dr. B.R. Ambedkar	Drafting the text of the Constitution based on B.N. Rau's preliminary draft (7 members: Ambedkar, Ayyangar, Ayyar, Munshi, Saadulla, Madhava Rau, T.T. Krishnamachari).
Union Powers Committee	Jawaharlal Nehru	Defining the scope of federal powers and legislative jurisdiction of the central Parliament.
Union Constitution Committee	Jawaharlal Nehru	Framing the executive, legislative, and judicial structure of the Union government.
Provincial Constitution Committee	Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel	Formulating the structural model for provincial governments and governors.
Advisory Committee on Fundamental Rights, Minorities & Tribals	Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel	Massive 54-member committee with sub-committees: Fundamental Rights (J.B. Kripalani), Minorities (H.C. Mookherjee), North-East Frontier Tribal Areas (Gopinath Bardoloi).
Steering Committee & Rules of Procedure	Dr. Rajendra Prasad	Managing the legislative agenda, debates, and procedural rules of the Assembly.

7.2 The Global Synthesis: Sources of the Indian Constitution

Far from being a mechanical imitation, the Indian Constitution was a creative synthesis adapted to India's unique social conditions:

Source / Constitution	Adopted / Adapted Constitutional Features
Government of India Act 1935	Federal scheme, office of Governor, judiciary, public service commissions, emergency provisions, administrative details (contributed nearly 60% of text).
British Constitution	Parliamentary form of government, rule of law, legislative procedure, single citizenship, cabinet system, prerogative writs, parliamentary privileges, bicameralism.
United States Constitution	Fundamental Rights, independence of judiciary, judicial review, impeachment of the President, removal of

Source / Constitution	Adopted / Adapted Constitutional Features
	Supreme Court and High Court judges, post of Vice-President.
Irish Constitution	Directive Principles of State Policy (DPSP), nomination of members to Rajya Sabha, method of election of President.
Canadian Constitution	Federation with a strong Centre, vesting of residuary powers in the Centre, appointment of state governors by the Centre, advisory jurisdiction of the Supreme Court.
Australian Constitution	Concurrent List, freedom of trade, commerce and intercourse, joint sitting of the two Houses of Parliament.
Weimar Constitution of Germany	Suspension of Fundamental Rights during Emergency.
Soviet (USSR) Constitution	Fundamental duties, ideal of justice (social, economic, and political) in the Preamble.
French Constitution	Republic and the ideals of Liberty, Equality, and Fraternity in the Preamble.
South African Constitution	Procedure for amendment of the Constitution and election of members of Rajya Sabha.

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Practice Questions: CUET UG Format

Q1. On which date did the Constituent Assembly of India hold its inaugural sitting in New Delhi?

(A) 9 December 1946
(B) 11 December 1946
(C) 13 December 1946
(D) 15 August 1947

Sol. Q1. The Constituent Assembly met for the very first time on 9 December 1946 in the Constitution Hall (now Central Hall of Parliament) in New Delhi, with Dr. Sachchidananda Sinha serving as interim Chairman.

Answer: (A)

Q2. Who among the following moved the historic **Objectives Resolution** in the Constituent Assembly on 13 December 1946?

(A) Dr. B.R. Ambedkar
(B) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
(C) Jawaharlal Nehru
(D) Dr. Rajendra Prasad

Sol. Q2. Jawaharlal Nehru moved the historic Objectives Resolution on 13 December 1946, defining the ideological values and goals of the Indian Republic. It was adopted unanimously on 22 January 1947.

Answer: (C)

Q3. Under the scheme formulated by the Cabinet Mission Plan of 1946, the members of the Constituent Assembly were:

(A) Directly elected by all Indian citizens on the basis of universal adult franchise
(B) Indirectly elected by the members of the Provincial Legislative Assemblies
(C) Nominated exclusively by the Governor-General in Council
(D) Elected through a nationwide plebiscite supervised by the British Parliament

Sol. Q3. Members of the Constituent Assembly were indirectly elected by the members of the Provincial Legislative Assemblies (elected under the 1935 Act in 1946) through proportional representation with the single transferable vote.

Answer: (B)

Q4. Who was the civil servant appointed as the **Constitutional Advisor** to the Constituent Assembly, who prepared the original draft of the Constitution?

(A) S.N. Mukherjee
(B) Sir Benegal Narsing Rau (B.N. Rau)
(C) K.M. Munshi
(D) V.P. Menon

Sol. Q4. Sir B.N. Rau served as the Constitutional Advisor to the Constituent Assembly, while S.N. Mukherjee was the Chief Draftsman.

Answer: (B)

Q5. Which member of the Constituent Assembly described separate electorates as a "poison that has entered into the body politic of our country" and led to Partition?

(A) Govind Ballabh Pant
(B) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
(C) Dr. B.R. Ambedkar
(D) Begum Aizaz Rasul

Sol. Q5. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel delivered this famous speech on 28 August 1947, denouncing separate electorates as an imperial device that divided Indian society and caused the Partition of the country.

Answer: (B)

Q6. Who was the only Muslim woman member of the Constituent Assembly who strongly opposed separate electorates as being self-destructive for minorities?

(A) Begum Aizaz Rasul
(B) Fatima Ismail
(C) Aruna Asaf Ali
(D) Captain Lakshmi Sahgal

Sol. Q6. Begum Aizaz Rasul was the sole Muslim woman member of the Constituent Assembly and took a courageous stand against separate electorates, arguing that joint electorates were vital for minority integration.

Answer: (A)

Q7. Jaipal Singh, who vigorously advocated for the protection and rights of tribal peoples in the Constituent Assembly, was a distinguished representative from which community?

(A) Gond
(B) Santhal
(C) Adivasi (Munda)
(D) Bhil

Sol. Q7. Jaipal Singh was an Oxford-educated Adivasi leader (Munda) from the Chhota Nagpur region who captained India's 1928 Olympic hockey team and championed indigenous tribal rights in the Assembly.

Answer: (C)

Q8. Which article of the Indian Constitution formally abolished the centuries-old discriminatory practice of **Untouchability** in all its forms?

(A) Article 14
(B) Article 15
(C) Article 17
(D) Article 19

Sol. Q8. Article 17 of the Indian Constitution explicitly abolishes Untouchability and forbids its practice in any form, making its enforcement an offense punishable in accordance with the law.

Answer: (C)

Q9. Who among the following members from Madras strongly cautioned the Assembly against excessive centralization, warning that provinces would become "beggars at the door of the Centre"?

(A) T.A. Ramalingam Chettiar
(B) K. Santhanam
(C) C. Rajagopalachari
(D) N. Gopalaswami Ayyangar

Sol. Q9. K. Santhanam from Madras delivered a rigorous critique of centralisation, arguing that stripping provinces of revenue powers would make provincial autonomy meaningless.

Answer: (B)

Q10. Under the federal division of powers in the Seventh Schedule of the Indian Constitution, **Residuary Powers** are vested in:

(A) The State Legislatures
(B) The Union Parliament
(C) The Supreme Court of India
(D) The Inter-State Council

Sol. Q10. Unlike the United States where residuary powers belong to the states, Article 248 of the Indian Constitution vests all residuary legislative powers exclusively in the Union Parliament.

Answer: (B)

Q11. Which member from the United Provinces provoked intense linguistic debate in the Constituent Assembly by aggressively demanding that Hindi in Devanagari script be made the sole national language?

(A) R.V. Dhulekar
(B) Purushottam Das Tandon
(C) Govind Ballabh Pant
(D) Acharya J.B. Kripalani

Sol. Q11. R.V. Dhulekar made aggressive speeches on the language question, stating that those who did not understand Hindustani had no right to remain in the Constituent Assembly.

Answer: (A)

Q12. Under the **Munshi-Ayyangar Formula** adopted by the Constituent Assembly, Hindi was designated as:

(A) The National Language of the Indian Union
(B) The Official Language of the Indian Union
(C) The Sole Medium of Higher Education
(D) The Link Language for Judicial Proceedings Only

Sol. Q12. The Munshi-Ayyangar formula designated Hindi in Devanagari script as the "Official Language" of the Union (Article 343), deliberately avoiding the term "National Language" to preserve regional linguistic harmony.

Answer: (B)

Q13. For how many years was the English language originally permitted to continue for all official purposes of the Union under the 1950 Constitution?

(A) 5 years
(B) 10 years
(C) 15 years
(D) 25 years

Sol. Q13. Article 343 provided that English would continue to be used for all official purposes of the Union for an initial transition period of 15 years (until 26 January 1965), which was later extended indefinitely by the Official Languages Act 1963.

Answer: (C)

Q14. How long did the Constituent Assembly take to complete the historic drafting of the Indian Constitution from its inaugural session to its final adoption?

(A) 1 year, 11 months, and 18 days
(B) 2 years, 11 months, and 18 days
(C) 3 years, 6 months, and 10 days
(D) 4 years, 2 months, and 15 days

Sol. Q14. The Constituent Assembly sat for 11 sessions spanning exactly 2 years, 11 months, and 18 days between its first sitting on 9 December 1946 and its adoption on 26 November 1949.

Answer: (B)

Q15. The date **26 January** was specifically chosen for the formal enforcement of the Indian Constitution in 1950 because:

(A) It was the birth anniversary of Mahatma Gandhi

(B) It marked the day the Quit India Movement was launched in 1942

(C) It commemorated the declaration of Purna Swaraj Day on 26 January 1930

(D) It was the day the Cabinet Mission Plan arrived in New Delhi in 1946

Sol. Q15. 26 January was chosen for the commencement of the Constitution to commemorate the historic Purna Swaraj Day (First Independence Day) celebrated on 26 January 1930 following the Lahore Congress resolution.

Answer: (C)

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